Reading Comprehension: Non-Fiction

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion

1. 5,895 metres above sea level.
2. Tanzania.
3. A) 'Mount Kilimanjaro is the tallest mountain in Africa.'
4. Enough energy to power a television for three hours.
5. Nearly half.
6. A) 'in my opinion'
7. Around one third.
8. Up to 60,000 bees.
9. A, B and E (the other statements are opinions about importance/difficulty, not facts).
10. Over 21,000 kilometres.
11. Over 2,000 years ago.
12. A) 'The Great Wall is the most impressive structure ever built.'
13. Between 9 and 11 hours.
14. Concentration and mood (also acceptable: memory).
15. A) A fact, since it is based on expert recommendations

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea

16. To persuade/advertise — to convince parents to buy the wrinkle-free school uniform.
17. A) Parents of school-age children
18. Persuasive, upbeat/enthusiastic, and reassuring.
19. To inform visitors about the gallery's opening hours and what they can see.
20. Neutral/informative and factual.
21. A) It gives practical information about visiting the Natural History Gallery
22. To present both sides of a discussion/debate about homework (a discursive, balanced purpose).
23. A) Balanced and even-handed
24. That there are valid arguments both for and against homework.
25. To persuade readers to donate money to the charity.
26. The general public/potential donors (likely adults who can give money).
27. A, B and C (no table of statistics or joke is used).
28. To instruct/explain how to carry out a process (a recipe method).
29. Neutral, clear, and instructional.
30. A) Chronological/sequential steps

Persuasive Techniques & Inference

31. A rhetorical question — it makes the reader pause and think, implying there is an obvious answer.
32. B) A statistic/expert opinion — it uses a number and experts' views to build trust.
33. 'fastest, strongest and most reliable' — three adjectives listed together for persuasive effect.
34. 'furious' — this emotionally charged word makes the reader feel sympathy or anger about the issue.

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35. A and C ('join the millions' is bandwagon appeal, and 'Don't miss out!' creates urgency; there is no rhetorical question or quotation).
36. It pairs a very small amount of money with a large outcome, making the donation feel like an easy, low-cost decision.
37. A) It exaggerates the reaction to grab the reader's attention.
38. A rhetorical question — it is phrased so there is really only one sensible answer, nudging the reader to agree.
39. The phrase 'before everyone else does' plays on the fear of missing out, encouraging quick action.
40. A and B ('clinically proven' is a claim of evidence, and 'thousands of happy customers' is bandwagon appeal).
41. 'drowning' — this dramatic word choice makes the problem feel urgent and serious, encouraging concern.
42. A) A rhetorical question — it invites the reader to agree there's no good reason to pay more.
43. The 'rule of three' — three positive qualities are listed together for persuasive effect.
44. It creates a sense of urgency, encouraging the reader to act immediately rather than delay.
45. A large number of people liking something does not prove scientifically that it is effective — popularity is not the same as proof.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion

1. 8,849 metres above sea level.
2. Nepal and China.
3. A) 'Mount Everest reaches 8,849 metres.'
4. Up to 500 years.
5. A small charge for plastic bags.
6. A) 'frankly'
7. Three.
8. Solve simple puzzles and open jars.
9. A, B and D (the other statements are opinions comparing octopuses to other animals).
10. Approximately 9.2 million square kilometres.
11. 45°C.
12. A) 'The Sahara is the most boring place to visit.'
13. Poorer sleep and reduced physical activity.
14. That it should be limited.
15. A) A fact, since it is presented as a finding from health guidelines/research

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea

16. To persuade/advertise — to encourage readers to join the gym.
17. A) Adults considering getting fitter
18. Persuasive, energetic/upbeat, and encouraging.
19. To inform the reader about tomorrow's weather forecast.
20. Neutral/informative and factual.
21. A) It gives a summary of tomorrow's expected weather
22. To present both sides of the debate about later school start times.
23. A) Balanced and even-handed
24. That there are reasonable arguments both for and against starting school later.
25. To persuade readers to support/donate to a wildlife conservation charity.
26. The general public/potential donors concerned about wildlife.
27. A, B and C (there is no diagram or joke in the extract).
28. To instruct readers on what to do during a fire alarm/drill.
29. Calm, clear, and instructional/authoritative.
30. A) Sequential/chronological instructions

Standard / Advanced

31. Bandwagon appeal — suggesting the reader should follow what many others already do.
32. A) Urgency — it pressures the reader to act quickly.
33. It makes the donation seem small and easy compared to the large outcome, encouraging the reader to give.
34. Exaggeration/emphasis — it dramatises the reaction to grab the reader's attention.
35. A rhetorical question — it nudges the reader towards agreeing there is only one sensible choice.
36. 'Isn't it time we asked what kind of world we are leaving behind?'
37. A) Contrast, to shock the reader into realising how wasteful this is.
38. 'clinically proven to reduce fine lines by 40%'

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39. A, B and C (there is no direct quotation from a dermatologist).
40. Many people liking something does not prove scientifically that it works — popularity is not the same as evidence.
41. 'drowning' and 'poisoning' — dramatic, emotionally charged words that make the problem feel urgent and serious.
42. A) To make the issue feel personally relevant to every reader.
43. 'faster, cheaper and more reliable' — three positive qualities listed together.
44. It sounds convincing but provides no real evidence to support it — a common persuasive trick.
45. A and B ('Act now' creates urgency, and 'thousands have already joined' is bandwagon appeal; there is no named statistic source or rhetorical question).

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